

Express: A Web Application Framework for Node.js

Express is a Node.js web application framework designed for building single-page, multi-page and hybrid web applications. Its design is minimalistic but it has many features available as plugins and enables rapid development of Node.js based Web applications.

Express is a minimal Node.js Web application framework and is based on the core HTTP module.

Last month, readers were introduced to Node.js. We are now ready to develop a Web application with the help of Express. Actually, Express is the backend of the MEAN stack (which comprises MongoDB, Express.js, Angular.js and Node.js).

Express is available on NPM and you can install it by running the command below:

```
$ npm install express --save
```

If you want to install Express temporarily, then there is no need to use the `--save` option. Express.js provides everything that the Connect component provides.

```
var connect = require('connect')
```

A simple example of Express app code is shown below:

```
var express = require('express');
var http = require('http');
```

```
var port = 3000;
```

```
// create an express application object
var app = express();
app.use(function(req, res, next) {
  res.end('Hello Express');
});
```

```
// register with http
http.createServer(app).listen(port);
```

Actually, in Line 1 from the above code, we get a function that we can call to create an Express application. This application object `app` has the behaviour of the Connect dispatcher.

Serving static pages

The NPM module `serve-static` is designed for serving static pages. Just create an HTML file, save it as `index.html` and

